

Luiz Gonzaga dos Santos Filho, MBA

 Vancouver, Canada  www.luiz.dev  Email  LinkedIn  Topmate  SpeakerDeck  GitHub

People-centric engineering leader with ~23.5 years scaling teams and orgs across Coursera, AWS, startups and government; currently leading the Developer Experience and the AI transformation for Coursera.

A life-long learner and teacher, [humbled by the people I've met along the way](#).

For a more verbose version of my resumé, visit luiz.dev/cv/verbose.

Experience

 Mentor @ Topmate.io

 Oct 2023 – present

- Top 1% mentor globally and top 100 in Canada

 Software Engineering Manager → Senior Software Engineering Manager @ Coursera

 Feb 2021 – present

- Led key new initiative post Coursera-Udemy merge: the combined company's biggest bet.
- Headed the AI Engineering transformation with positive ROI: increasing productivity and stable quality
- Timely delivered Enterprise growth initiatives: unlocking millions of dollars in recurring revenue with no additional headcount
- Saved \$XXX,XXX per quarter with improved cross-dept processes, metrics and accountability, improving executive decision-making, increasing hiring throughput, etc
- Organizational growth: led several teams and charters, hired and promoted engineers to Senior, Staff, Sr. Staff and Manager
- Championed strong team culture and well-being by authoring and driving different org-wide policies around DE&I, increasing our hiring pipeline's diversity by ~10% and maintaining highest team retention in the org

 Software Engineering Manager II → Software Engineering Manager III @ Amazon / AWS

 Sep 2017 – Dec 2020

- At Amazon Payments: led a cross-functional team to deliver the end-to-end payments integration for Amazon Turkey (amazon.com.tr), involving international and cross-department collaboration and materializing Amazon's expansion in Europe; drove early adoption of PSD2 regulations, ensuring European market compliance ahead of competitors; owned Payment on Delivery for India market
- At AWS Route53: hired and grew a team from scratch; measurably improved operational efficiency, accessibility, and usability across five different products; owned multiple product roadmaps and delivered two global product launches, expanding AWS Route53's presence into new markets and regions
- Drove organizational change and fostered inclusion: improved our sourcing efficiency by ~32% and our pipeline's diversity by ~11%; championed an engineering-wide policy to promote inclusion and belonging; as a certified Cultural Competences for Teams instructor, trained hundreds of leaders and engineers around diversity and inclusion
- Mentored and supported other managers: served on the Software Engineering Manager Peer Advisory board, providing guidance and support to peers

 Senior Frontend Engineer → Frontend Team Lead @ Brandwatch

 Apr 2016 – Feb 2017

- As the Frontend team lead: helped the PM with agile ceremonies and backlog prioritization; liaison with the team manager in the UK headquarters
- As a Senior Frontend Engineer: worked existing and new feature development on Brandwatch's main product (Analytics); refactored thousands of files on a 5-year-old jQuery codebase, improving bundle size, patching security vulnerabilities, and enabling new features to be used

 Full-stack engineer @ X-Team

 Apr 2015 – Apr 2015

- Short collaboration with X-Team's CTO researching, planning and developing the next phase of X-Labs (their open source initiative) and other internal projects involving IndexedDB

 Software Engineering Manager @ DataEasy

 Jun 2014 – Mar 2016

- Led Engineering Transformation: directed a company-wide shift to modern DevOps and ChatOps practices, including Git, SemVer, CI pipelines, live application monitoring, automated release management, enabling higher quality and faster releases and allowing the IT department to stay leaner
- Championed Process Improvement: mapped all engineering processes, reduced touchpoints and staffing needs

- Fostered growth and upskilling: partnered with a local university to provide automated testing courses for senior engineers, streamlining testing cycles and reducing release bottlenecks
- Cultivated Innovation and Learning: created a bi-weekly program fostering innovation and knowledge sharing through tech talks and experimentation with new technologies

Senior Frontend Engineer @ Brandwatch

 Apr 2013 – Nov 2013

- Worked on their main product line: Brand Analytics
- In addition to feature work, defined conventions and wrote codemods to refactor thousands of files across a dozen teams, reducing diff sizes and code reviewing times

Senior Frontend Engineer → Frontend Team Lead @ Content Fleet

 Apr 2012 – Mar 2013

- Worked on their main Analytics application during the startup's growth phase
- While keeping crucial time-to-market velocity, led mobile responsiveness efforts and performance optimization initiatives, significantly reducing network calls and minimizing source code for a faster UX, especially on mobile devices, going from yellow to green on Lighthouse
- Responsible for the frontend strategy, conventions, quality, performance improvements and training new team members

Full-stack Engineer @ Goiás State Government

 Feb 2007 – Mar 2012

- Worked as a full-stack java engineer on the Government's Human Capital Management (HCM) system, supporting payroll and other features for 200k+ people
- Led several performance, usability and accessibility improvements around page load reductions, ease of use, decrease of time to action and others

Junior Full-stack Engineer @ DR Sistemas & Interagi

 2004 – 2005

- Interagi: developed CRUD applications and did some programmatic image processing
- DR Sistemas: developed a Backend application for the public law sector

Misc Software Engineering & Consultancy gigs @ Freelancer

 Jan 2003 – Dec 2014

- Vega Sistemas, Brazil: High-level architecture on migrating a desktop application to a web platform
- SENAC Goiás, Brazil: Consultancy on web development best practices, productivity tools, agile methodologies and programming languages for their internal development department
- Federal University of Goiás, Brazil: Developed their public admission (Vestibular) system and website

Other

Over 23 experiences as an instructor or speaker and 7 volunteer positions around leadership, web development, community and the arts. See all of them at luiz.dev/cv/verbose.

Education

Degrees

- Business Process Management, MBA @ IT Management Institute (IGTI) – Brazil
- Computer Engineering, Bachelor @ Federal University of Goiás – Brazil
- Computer Science, Visiting Student @ Saint Mary's University – Canada

Languages

- Portuguese — Native
- English — Fluent
- German & Spanish — Basic

Other

Over 33 courses and specializations taken, 73 books read, 32 events attended and 8 achievements on software engineering, entrepreneurship, leadership and self growth. See all of them at luiz.dev/cv/verbose.

Skills and Competencies

12 factor apps agile methodologies art aws b2b backbone bdd bpm budgeting business process management candidate sourcing career growth coaching communication community continuous integration cross-functional collaboration css cvs de&i (diversity, equity & inclusion) delivery management devops docker documentation ed-tech education effective communication enterprise event management external communication flux freetest github google apps scripts hibernate highcharts hiring html internal communication jasmine java ee javascript jenkins jira jquery jsp kanban leadership leveldb management marketing maven mentoring mentorship

mongodb monitoring mustache mysql new relic ngo node non-profit operational efficiency organizational strategy payment services people management
performance metrics phantom php pivotal tracker policy development postmortem process process improvement product development product launch project management
public relations public speaking react remote collaboration require requirejs rest resume revenue growth risk management route 53 scrum semver shell script
software development software development life cycle software engineering software quality software testing spiritualism sql stakeholder engagement stakeholder management
struts svn tape team management testlink theater time managing underscore user experience velocity vendor relationship web development web services